

## Here's the excerpt from the interview we had with Scott Apeland, Director Developer Network at Intel and Narendra Bhandari, Director, Asia Pacific, Intel Software and Solutions Group.

**Q. How is Intel® establishing its relationship with its whole developer community in India?**

**What is your real say or plan in engaging them in say three to five years from now.**

**A.** Intel® has actually had strong relations with software developers for many years. Although we are a hardware company, we provide microprocessor software and is a critical component for us to really help end users to take advantage of the technologies. It's through the software that they do that, so it's been critical for a long time. We have programs specifically dedicated for software developers, so that's my area of responsibility. Worldwide software partner program, software network and academic initiatives are really business-oriented programs for companies to partner with Intel® to take advantage of the technology and grow their business. At our Intel® developer forum just two months ago, we announced that we have retail partners as well, and not just OEMs such as ASUS and ACER putting them in devices, but retail partners such as Best Buy in the US, Croma in India and Dixons in the UK. These are leaders in their space, and bundle it pre-installed and market it to their users

and that's happening now. It's a kind of next step in this process. It's giving it to consumers' hands, marketing it to them and then creating that pool for developers so they can make money and get excited and write more applications. The whole process right now is to roll

out the retail piece of this.

**Q. Give examples of what kind of applications Best buy or Croma would be integrating into their netbooks ?**

**A.** The popular categories are games, where a lot of applications are coming in. Another type of content for which apps come in are travel resource, because a lot of the netbook users are mobile, on the go, maybe even family vacation travellers, there are some health-related applications such as exercise programs to monitor your health, city guides, education stuff and so on.



**SCOTT APELAND**  
DIRECTOR DEVELOPER  
NETWORK INTEL

**Q. So do you first find out the need in the market and then communicate it to the developers, or is it the other way around where developers themselves identify the need and create apps for the consumers?**

**A.** I would say it's both. Our initiative in this regard was Ideate Up where we went to the consumers and asked them what kind of apps they would like to use.

It wasn't a formal survey or any focus groups involved. We just told them to tell us about their dream app and write about it. In a few weeks, we got over 650 ideas from people and these were filtered ideas, not trash. Users actually voted on the best ones and they got converted



**NARENDRA BHANDARI**  
DIRECTOR, ASIA PACIFIC  
INTEL SOFTWARE AND  
SOLUTIONS GROUP

into applications. So we just rolled out Ideate Up in India and saw some tremendous response from both developers and consumers. A quarter of the apps published in the website have come from India, and Indian developers have the second largest base in AppUp<sup>SM</sup>.

**Q. At the industry level there is a lot of competition in terms of different companies having their own platforms for developers. So do you see any**

**convergence of platforms happening. What are your views on this this?**

**A.** Meego, which is a Linux-based mobile version, is an open platform driven by the Linux foundation with main contributors as Intel® and Nokia which will solve a lot of problems that some developers, partners and even consumers are seeing today. So from a developers perspective, he/she is having to write his/her application for one platform and then write it for a completely different operating system, rewrite the whole code multiple times. One of the big benefits of Meego is that you have one operating system across all these devices and fairly easily can modify your app for a specific device user experience and reduce cost quite substantially. Similarly, from an OEM or service provider's point of view, they can also look and say there is one store, one software platform that would run across tablets, phones, netbooks, TVs and all the other devices they want to reach. More importantly, their investment also goes down quite substantially as well.

Linux from Intel®. The Intel® AppUp<sup>SM</sup> developer program supports both native development, and development of applications which use a runtime. Currently the AppUp<sup>SM</sup> developer program includes an SDK for native development using C/C++ on Windows, or using .NET, a beta SDK is available for the Moblin Linux platform as well in both rpm, and deb package formats.

Intel® AppUp<sup>SM</sup> developer program

also supports runtime technologies such as Adobe AIR, Microsoft Silverlight and Java. While Java and Silverlight are currently only on the roadmap, the Adobe AIR SDK is available right now for both AIR 1.5.3 using Flex 3.5.1 and AIR 2.0 using Flex 4.1. These platform and runtimes are not final, as Intel® will keep its eye open for future developments in the field, and may include other programming languages and runtimes.

Interested in developing apps for the Intel® AppUp<sup>SM</sup> center? Register at the Intel® AppUp<sup>SM</sup> developer program, and participate in the Digit Application Developer Contest to win exciting prizes such as Netbooks, MP3 Players, 8GB Pen Drives, and a lot more. Also, once you register to the program, you can submit your apps and get a chance to own a custom-ordered BMW - plus a trip to Germany to pick it up. ■